

22 May 2026

Catch of the Week season winner!



Our Catch of the Week season winner is Hunter Clark! The 11-year-old caught this kingfish while fishing from a kayak near Stoney Bay, Coromandel (with his father close by on a jetski). After three days of trying to catch a fish, his persistence paid off when he finally landed the kingfish. Hunter refused any assistance and paddled the kayak nearly 3km back to shore on his own. The fish was later cut into steaks and shared around the campground.

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Member of the New Zealand Community Newspapers Association



The PC Times 20 years ago:
19 May 2006: Clevedon maritime village row hots up as submission deadline nears.



PINE HARBOUR ELECTRICAL

Weekly Tide Chart

22 Fri		5:30am ▼ 0.7m	11:50am ▲ 3.2m	
23 Sat		12:17am ▲ 3.3m	6:29am ▼ 0.8m	
24 Sun		1:15am ▲ 3.2m	7:28am ▼ 0.8m	
25 Mon		2:12am ▲ 3.2m	8:26am ▼ 0.9m	
26 Tue		3:08am ▲ 3.1m	9:22am ▼ 0.9m	
27 Wed		4:02am ▲ 3.0m	10:15am ▼ 0.9m	
28 Thu		4:53am ▲ 3.0m	11:05am ▼ 0.9m	

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Editorial by Kawakawa Bay Community Association

An update on how the Kawakawa Bay community prepared for cyclone Vaianu that was forecast to have a significant impact on our community

On Saturday 11 April a preparedness review meeting was held at the Fire Station. Those that attended were the fire brigade, KBCA, the boat club, The Kawakawa Bay/Ōrere Health Clinic and First Response.

At this meeting our readiness, potential risks and mitigation plans were discussed. Andrea Couldry was able to update the meeting on how the community hall had been set up with food rations, broadband communications, backup power, grab bags and all the other equipment that the community association had purchased with the grant that we had received.

Fortunately, the impact of the cyclone was not as devastating as was forecast. Having said this, it was comforting to know that as a community we had prepared for the worst.

Rāhui discussed

Ongoing breaches of shellfish collection limits have been a hot topic in Kawakawa Bay and Ōrere Point for many years, and our local iwi, Ngāti Paoa, are keen to realise a solution. The Kawakawa Bay Community Association was approached by Wharekawa Marae, to see if the community could advocate for and support Ngāti Paoa in their plan for a rāhui/temporary ban on taking kai moana and crustaceans from the

coastline between Kawakawa Bay and Ōrere Point.

A special meeting was held prior to the monthly Kawakawa Bay Community Association meeting on Monday 13 April. At the meeting, a representative from Ngāti Paoa and members of the Ōrere Marine Initiative outlined the rationale for the rāhui (specified to shellfish, not including snapper and other fish species). Their presentation also covered the process of implementing and policing a rāhui including explaining the “tikanga” (the right way of doing things, from the iwi’s perspective) and how they might go about obtaining a temporary closure of a fishing area or restriction on fishing methods under section 186A of the Fisheries Act 1996.

The meeting was attended by many people from the community and Association members; a quorum was present. Also present were two members of the Franklin Local Board.

Post the presentation the floor was opened for questions which were answered by Ngāti Paoa representative and members of the Ōrere Marine Initiative.

At the end of question time, KBCA Chair Derek Nielsen made the motion:

That KBCA support the proposal to implement a rāhui/ban (specified to shellfish not including snapper and other species of fish).

The motion was seconded by the KBCA secretary and put to the floor to vote on.

The vote was passed with one vote against the proposal. The motion was carried.

We would like to thank the representatives from Ngāti Paoa and the Ōrere Marine Initiative for taking the time to present at the special meeting. The KBCA looks forward to collaborating with them to advance the proposal and have the rāhui, including 186A of the Fisheries Act 1996, implemented.

The KBCA is also seeking assistance from those in our community who have grown up in the Bay. What we would like are testimonials/stories of what the shore marine life used to be like. We are keen to know things like how the shellfish numbers have declined, the significant reduction in size of some species like cockles, and areas where the mussels have been “wiped out.” What is particularly important is how the removal of creatures like crabs, snails and other sea life has impacted on catching fish from the shore, as these creatures are very much part of that food chain. We are looking for as many statements as possible.

The Kawakawa Bay community has also met with the Ōrere Marine Initiative team to share information and progress on how as a group, this project can be implemented.

Council appeals Sunfield fast-track decision

Auckland Council has lodged an appeal against the fast-track approval granted to the Sunfield development, reopening debate on the controversial Ardmore/Takaanini project.

Winton Limited’s Sunfield development was approved through the Government’s Fast-track process in March 2026. The “car-less” development near Ardmore airport will deliver approximately 3,800 new homes, a town centre, retail and healthcare services, retirement villages, and parks and reserves. Supporters say the project will deliver housing and infrastructure, while opponents have raised concerns about environmental impacts and lack of infrastructure planning.

Auckland Council Director of Policy, Planning and Governance, Megan Tyler, says: “Auckland Council has appealed the fast-track consenting panel’s decision to approve the Sunfield development. The council believes the panel made three legal errors in reaching its conclusion by not fully considering the impact on water and wastewater infrastructure, highly productive land, and importantly, stormwater and flood risks.

“While Auckland Council supports enabling housing that creates choices for people, it cannot support largescale developments in areas with limited infrastructure and that would pose flood risks to residents. The council does not believe the panel has fully considered these important matters under the law.”



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Helen Pinfold’s fur ‘girls’ ready to find new homes

What began as a search for the perfect wedding coat has turned into a five-year passion project for Helen Pinfold, the self-confessed “crazy fur coat lady from Beachlands”.

The fur collection began in 2021 when Helen began searching for a fur coat and stoles to wear at her Queenstown wedding. She then bought a selection of stoles for her bridesmaids to choose from, which she jokes helped justify buying so many in the beginning. She then bought more, with the intention of providing them for guests to wear at her wedding, although the practicality of transporting them all from Beachlands to Queenstown meant she didn’t follow through on this plan.

“Then I had a girlfriend who got married in Taupō, so she used some of my furs, and I thought, well, I could just let people know I’ve got furs, and if anybody needed to use them for weddings or photography or things like that, then they could.”

That mindset fuelled the buying, and Helen now owns about 145 pieces including stoles, wraps, shrugs and coats. But with the collection now filling spare bedrooms, she has decided it is time to let some of them go.

“Now I’ve realised ‘Helen, you went overboard, and you’ve got too many. You cannot have them all for yourself. It’s time to share the love. And so the girls are available to distribute.’”



Helen Pinfold with some of her fur collection, now offered for sale.

The “girls” are what Helen calls her furs. Each one is individually named. Ethel, Agnes and Nora sit alongside Felicity, Amelia and Gladys.

“Each piece was something, and was something special to someone, so they deserve a name,” she says.

She acknowledges that people have differing views on the ethics of wearing animal skins.

“To me it’s like honouring the animal that once was. They’re not in a landfill, or lining a dog’s bed. But it’s more than that, because these also all have a story about the women that once wore them.”

Helen estimates she has spent around \$15,000-20,000 on the collection. The most expensive coat, ‘Briar’, cost \$1200 and is now used as a cosy throw on her

couch. Another coat, ‘Tiffany’, cost \$400 - making it a surprise when Helen later discovered an original price tag of almost \$5,000 hidden in its pocket.

Some pieces carry personal connections. ‘Beryl’ was purchased from Akaroa, where Helen’s birth mother once lived. Others came from deceased estates, including a small collection bought through Bentleys via Trade Me.

One mink coat, which Helen named ‘Sophia’ (after Sophia Lauren) has been a source of comfort this year. Helen’s son died of cancer when he was just three and a half. He would have been 40 this year. Helen says she wrapped herself in the fur during his anniversary month. “And it was really comforting. Then I realised a little bit later on that I’d just cleaned the toilet.

So it’s like, I’ve just cleaned the toilet in my mink coat!”

Her coats don’t sit in the wardrobe, unused. She recently wore ‘Tiffany’, a 7/8-length brown mink and squirrel coat, to a movie-date with her son to see The Devil Wears Prada, and paired ‘Alice’, a stole, with jeans to wear to her father’s 90th birthday.

“These aren’t just for balls - you can just wear them as part of your style.”

The decision to sell some of the furs has picked up pace since Helen posted about the collection on the Pōhutukawa Coast Grapevine. “Then of course the DMs went off and the comments and the likes and the love hearts and the wows and the comments and all of that. So here we are.”

One visitor to the Coast has already

bought seven coats and is returning to buy another five. Others have travelled from out of town, including a woman who stopped in before flying home after a funeral. “She’s now taking ‘Betty’ back to Cromwell,” Helen says.

While Helen loves her collection and says the coat collecting was a source of joy during Covid times, now is the time to part with some of them.

“Hubby’s quite keen to reclaim the guest bedroom. I can’t keep them all and the girls are ready for someone else to love them.”

Anyone interested in viewing the fur collection can contact Helen via email: helenpinfold.senegence@gmail.com.



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Howick College seeks feedback about including Clevedon/Brookby in zone

Until now, secondary school aged students from Clevedon and Brookby have had to apply out of zone to attend Howick College. That could be about to change.

Howick College’s Board of Trustees has been working with the Ministry of Education on a proposal to amend its school enrolment scheme to include Clevedon and Brookby.

All ākonga/learners who live within the home zone of Howick College will be entitled to attend the school and those that live outside the home zone may be accepted if there are out-of-zone places available and an application meets legislative requirements through an official ballot process.

Some boundary roads will overlap with the boundaries of Papakura High School and Alfriston College. Students living within the zone overlaps have a right to enrol at either school.

Kawakawa Bay and Orere Point students are not included within the new zone.

Over the past decade both Clevedon and Brookby schools have been part of the Kāhui Ako (Communities of Learning) which saw them work collaboratively with Howick College. The Kāhui Ako initiative was disestablished early this year by the government.

Clevedon School Principal Edeh Sullivan says her school has worked closely with

the Ministry of Education over the past two years to be included within the Howick College zone.

“We are thrilled that the process has now reached this stage,” she says.

“This proposal has the potential to be of significant benefit for our tamariki, providing a clearer pathway to college and helping keep groups of students together as they transition beyond Year 8.”

While encouraged by the progress, Edeh says Clevedon School is keen to see some refinements to the proposed zone.

“At present, a sizeable portion of our community is not included within the outlined map. We would encourage whānau to take the time to review the proposal and provide thoughtful feedback during the consultation period.

“Nothing is finalised yet, so while we are optimistic and celebrating this milestone, we are also hopeful that adjustments can be made to ensure more of our families are included.”

Brookby School’s Board of Trustees is also pleased to see the proposed amendment to the Howick College enrolment scheme reach the consultation stage, including the addition of the Brookby area, saying it reflects several years of work behind the scenes.

“Brookby School has a strong relationship with Howick College, with many students already connecting through friendships,

sport, and extracurricular activities with those in the current zone. Our community has long sought in-zone access to Howick College, and this change would provide a valuable and well-aligned pathway for our students,” says Brookby School Principal Wayne Gillard.

“I would like to see the inclusion of the full Clevedon School zone, ensuring all

local families have this opportunity.”

More information including a proposed zone map is available at education.govt.nz - search for Howick College.

Feedback on the proposed zone changes can be made via email to auckland.enrolmentschemes@education.govt.nz.

Consultation closes Friday 29 May 2026.

Residents asked for skatepark feedback

What’s your local skate park like? If you live in the Beachlands/Maraetai area, the answer is probably ‘terrible’.

If you have strong feelings about your local skate park, now is the time to unleash them - Auckland Council is seeking feedback about skatepark use. Feedback from the consultation will be used to develop a regional skatepark plan for Tāmaki Makaurau.

Both Clevedon and the Pōhutukawa Coast have skate facilities. The Franklin Local Board has allocated \$100,000 within its work plan to carry out remedial work on the Te Puru skate facility to make the area safer and more useable until a more permanent solution can be found.

Deputy Mayor Desley Simpson urges Aucklanders to take part in the Have Your Say consultation.

“To keep these spaces safe, well-designed and future-ready, we need to hear from the people who use them. Your feedback will directly shape how skateparks are planned for and improved across Auckland, so I encourage everyone to have their say.”

The project focuses on skateparks and skate spaces in Auckland Council parks and community facilities, including the design, location, supporting facilities, smaller skate elements in parks, like ramps and rails. It does not include skating or riding outside council-managed parks spaces.

Feedback will help the council identify priorities for investment and inform future planning, design and upgrades.

Consultation is open until Monday 1 June 2026 at akhaveyoursay.aucklandcouncil.govt.nz/skateparks

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OCEANIA Believe in Better

Young Hūnua musician among teens taking the stage at Hawkins Theatre

A group of talented 15 and 16-year-olds are set to prove that great music has no age limit, with an ambitious self-organised concert coming to Papakura’s Hawkins Theatre on 23 May.

Among the young performers is Hūnua local Ben Frost. Ben’s family have lived in Hūnua for generations, and his grandmother served as both a teacher and later principal at Hūnua School. Ben himself attended Hunua School from Year 1 through to Year 8, where his musical journey began with the school’s ukulele group before he progressed to guitar lessons with a music teacher who visited the school.

He now plays lead guitar, writes original music, and more recently has taken on the role of stage management and promotion for the upcoming Slim Jims concert.

Ben joined the Slim Jims in 2025. That year they performed at the nationally renowned Rockquest competition, before going on to compete in Auckland

Council’s Stand Up Stand Out (SUSO) showcase, where they made it to the semifinals stage.

Now the Slim Jims are offering the wider community an opportunity to enjoy their music at the Hawkins Theatre. The teens have secured the venue, are managing all event logistics, and are doing the bulk of the work themselves.

Their setlist leans towards classic rock and pop, with covers of artists including Foo Fighters, Coldplay, Red Hot Chili Peppers, and Rage Against the Machine, alongside original compositions. The band are particularly known for their renditions of Foo Fighters’ *Everlong*, Red Hot Chili Peppers’ *Snow (Hey Oh)* and *Can’t Stop*, and Coldplay’s *Clocks* and *Fix You*.

The Slim Jims concert will be held this Saturday 23 May at the Hawkins Theatre. Tickets are available online at hawkinstheatre.co.nz/theatre-events/slim-jims/.



Ben Frost, playing lead guitar at last year’s Stand Up Stand Out semifinals. Image supplied.

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E-scooter up for grabs in local climate action competition

A brand new electric scooter is up for grabs, as the Pōhutukawa Coast Youth Council (PCYC) invites local rangatahi and whānau to take part in a fun new climate action competition.

The initiative, which can be found at pcyc.nz/flipthetriangle, encourages residents to take simple, practical steps towards sustainability while learning more about climate action.

To enter, participants complete an action from one of seven climate action steps and share what they’ve done via a video or photos posted to social media tagging @teampcyc, emailed to team@pcyc.nz, or submitted through the website form.

Entrants must also submit a community climate project idea for Auckland Council to consider running locally.

The seven climate action steps cover a broad range of everyday choices, from championing change and eating low-carbon food such as vegetarian meals, to reducing reliance on fossil fuels, saving energy at home, choosing sustainable travel like cycling or public transport, cutting back on fast fashion, and creating green spaces by planting trees or growing vegetables.

Entries will be judged on three criteria: the most innovative new idea to make a climate difference; the most impactful act

relating to one of the seven steps; and the action most likely to be sustained over time.

Prizes include a Honey Whale Electric Scooter E9T, with second and third prizes each being Tui Worm Farm kits, along with gardening tools for the runner-up.

Follow the Pōhutukawa Coast Youth Council on Instagram and TikTok at @team.pcyc, or on Facebook at @Pōhutukawa Coast Youth Council, to find out more.

COP SHOP NEWS

Counties Manukau East Police and community thank Pōhutukawa Coast Crime Watch Patrol

New Zealand Police, alongside the Pōhutukawa Coast community, extend heartfelt thanks to the volunteers of the Pōhutukawa Coast Crime Watch Patrol for their continued commitment to keeping local neighbourhoods safe and connected.

Community patrols are a cornerstone of grassroots safety efforts across New Zealand. Through a visible and proactive presence, they help deter crime, support Police, and strengthen community trust. The Pōhutukawa Coast Community Patrol exemplifies this role, contributing countless voluntary hours to support the wellbeing of the area. Their work goes beyond observation. A patrol vehicle on the road provides reassurance to residents, businesses, and visitors, reinforcing that the community is actively cared for. This visibility helps reduce opportunities for offending while encouraging shared responsibility for safety.

A key contribution is the Patrol’s involvement in Operation Beaches during the busy summer period. As visitor numbers increase, volunteers play an important role in supporting a safe and orderly

environment, allowing families and visitors to enjoy the coastline with confidence.

Throughout the year, the Patrol remains a consistent presence, conducting routine patrols, reporting suspicious behaviour, and supporting community events. While much of their work happens behind the scenes, its impact is felt across the Pōhutukawa Coast.

Central to their success is a strong partnership with New Zealand Police. Patrol members act as the “eyes and ears” of Police, providing valuable information that supports timely responses, while Police provide guidance and support to ensure volunteers operate safely and effectively. This collaboration strengthens the overall safety network and reinforces community connections.

The Pōhutukawa Coast Community Patrol embodies volunteerism, civic pride, and service. Their dedication enhances not only safety but also the sense of belonging that makes the Pōhutukawa Coast a special place to live.

New Zealand Police and the wider community thank every member of the Pōhutukawa Coast Crime Watch Patrol for your dedication, professionalism, and ongoing contribution to community safety.





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SPORTS

Beachlands Maraetai Football Club

RESULTS FROM 16-17 MAY

Womens First Team vs Takapuna W2, 1-4
Atletico Beach vs Ellerslie AFC W.S., 15-1
Legionnaires vs Fencibles United AFC Melchester Wreckers, 2-2
Rebels vs Western Springs Goldenballs, 3-2
Lions vs SAR Nadro, 2-14
Coasters vs Manurewa AFC Wonderous, 1-2
First Team vs Bucklands Beach AFC, 0-6
First Team vs Bucklands Beach AFC, 5-0
Blue 15G vs Auckland United Football Club Argenta 15G, 3-1



Above: Y4 Navy - TOD Bryn Colenso, POD Oliver Lawrence



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Beachlands Maraetai Junior Rugby

RESULTS FROM 16 MAY

Beachlands Maraetai U11 Girls Mako Navy vs Beachlands Maraetai U11 Girls Mako Orange, 70-85
Beachlands Maraetai U13 Girls Mako Orange vs Waiheke Tamure U13 Rippa Girls, 75-30
Beachlands Maraetai U13 Girls Mako Navy vs Marist Eastern Blue U13 Girls Rip, 5-80
Waiheke Tohora U15 Rip Girls vs Beachlands Maraetai U15 Girls Mako Orange, 70-15
Beachlands Maraetai U15 Girls Mako Navy vs Marist Eastern Blue Diamonds U15 Girls Rip, 95-40
Eden Kowhai A U17 Girls Rippa vs Beachlands Maraetai U17 Girls Mako Navy, 65-110
Beachlands Maraetai Sharks U85 vs Fraser Tech U85 KG, 29-24
Manurewa Year 1 Green vs Beachlands Maraetai Year 1 Navy Mako, 40-40
Manurewa Year 2 White vs Beachlands Maraetai Year 2 Mako Orange, 0-0
Papakura Wasps Year 2 Black vs Beachlands Maraetai Year 2 Mako Navy, 0-0
Beachlands Maraetai Year 3 Mako Navy vs Ardmore Marist Year 3 Blue, 50-50
Karaka Year 3 Wild Boars vs Beachlands Maraetai Year 3 Mako Orange, 0-0
Beachlands Maraetai Year 4 Mako Navy vs Patumahoe Year 4 Blue, 20-65
Beachlands Maraetai Year 4 Mako Orange vs Papakura Wasps Year 4, 35-60
Beachlands Maraetai Year 5 Mako Navy vs Ardmore Marist Year 5 Red, 50-25
Beachlands Maraetai Year 6 Mako Navy vs Pukekohe Year 6 Green, 70-0
Beachlands Maraetai Year 7 Mako vs Bombay Year 7 Gold, 64-12
Beachlands Maraetai Year 8 Mako vs Maramarua Year 8, 40-26

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Challengers U6 POD AJ Garner
Chaos U6 POD Pippa Fitzpatrick
Cannons U7 POD Stevie Chambers
Cheetahs U7 Merit Amaru Albert
Chasers U7 POD Lachlan Elstob
Coyotes U8 POD Scott Baldwin, Merit Award Shaan Dhanaser
Comets U8 POD Noah Scorrar, Merit Award Hugo Bull
Cardinals U9 POD Rayan Attraqchi, Merit Award Neal Tiwary
Chiefs U11 v Drury, POD Ferg Nielsen-Vickers, Merit Award Indie Waters
Colts U13 v Liverpool Onehunga Mangere, POD Jack Harris



Above: U8 Coyotes - Scott Baldwin and Shaan Dhanaser



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By-election candidate calls for action on infrastructure, flood maps and a long-overdue secondary school

- by Franklin Local Board by-election candidate Tom Van der Laan

As part of my campaign to be elected to the Franklin Local Board I recently visited Whitford, Beachlands, Clevedon, Kawakawa Bay and Orere Point. I loved the work done on foreshore resilience at Maraetai, but the closure of the coastal route to Duders reinforced that this should be a continuing focus for the Council. Further out at Kawakawa and Matingarahi it was clear that roading and foreshore infrastructure need more attention – something I will be advocating strongly for if elected to the Franklin Local Board.

However, on the flip side of this issue, is the real concern about the Council adoption of IPCC 8.5 scenarios in its ‘Flood Viewer Maps’ which overlay many Wairoa properties. This scenario predicts 1.4m sea level rise and associated extreme weather-flooding events by 2090 and overlays these onto our LIM’s (Land Information / Property titles) which could impact both property development potential, property value and insurance costs. Just this week however, the IPCC itself has publicly announced that the 8.5 scenario is

‘implausible’! If elected I will agitate strongly to have the Council review and change these models.

I also enjoyed visiting some of our local halls and recreation facilities on my trip. I fully support maintaining these important local assets which do so much to support community connectivity.

A few Beachland’s locals also emphasized the need for a local high school - something that has been talked about, but not actioned. As a former principal, I am in a good position to talk to education officials and try to get some traction on this.

It seems a lot of locals are not aware of this by-election. Voting papers arriving this week will hopefully stimulate a good voting turnout. As a retired person, I have the time to be an effective representative for our area, the time to get out and about, the time to connect, listen and the time to work at getting good outcomes for Wairoa residents. With significant previous experience on elected boards, including educational and economic steering groups in Franklin, I can be the person who makes things happen!



Tom Van der Laan



Local Views

Local Vision

Local Voice

Local Board

Independent Candidate

Authorised by: Thomas J Van der Laan – t.vanderlan@gmail.com

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Weighty matters – your questions answered



- by Dr Samuel Frost BVSc,
Veterinarian and Branch Manager

Thanks to those who submitted questions for our monthly column. We wanted to address one of the more common questions that people ask, which is about weight loss! In our article last month, we talked about arthritis in older dogs and how excess weight on their joints can contribute to pain and discomfort, so heading into winter, weight loss becomes quite important.

Why are so many cats and dogs overweight? It's about satiety, or the feeling of being full. Some of our pets can just eat and eat and never feel full. In fact, it has only recently been found that up to 25% of Labradors have a genetic mutation that reduces their ability to recognise when they are full! As well as that, removing the influence of testosterone or oestrogen can lead to weight gain in both dogs and cats



after desexing. Exercise is important, but for most of our pets, the route to weight loss isn't mainly about increasing exercise. That's because there's a limit to how much exercise we can put overweight dogs and cats through. Gentle exercise is important, but it's more important to focus on reducing their calorie intake.

Reducing their calories can be achieved by lowering the amount of food being fed, but the most effective way is to feed them low-calorie food. We have good options for low-calorie foods available at our clinic, and our fantastic team would be happy to help you work out the right approach for your pet.

If you have questions about any other pet related topic you'd like us to cover in future articles, we'd love to hear from you. Send in your questions via email to beachlands@fvs.co.nz with the subject line "PC Times Question".



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Franklin Local Board by-election candidate profile: Chris Caldwell

The recent resignation of Franklin Local Board member Malcolm Bell means that a by-election will be held in June, to determine a third candidate to represent the board's Wairoa area (which includes Beachlands, Maraetai, Clevedon, Hūnua, Kawakawa Bay and Ōrere Point). Over the next few week's the PC Times will publish interviews with the four candidates standing for election. This week's interview is with candidate Chris Caldwell..

Can you share your personal connection to the Wairoa subdivision and how your experiences here shape the perspective you would bring to the Local Board?

My personal connection to the Wairoa subdivision is extensive. I have worked closely with the Drury Community Committee for a number of years and have closely followed the planning and land use changes in the area due to the guidelines set in the Auckland City Council Unitary Plan.

I have had a boat berthed at Pine Harbour Marina for for over 20 years and have seen massive changes in the population and makeup of the area over the years.

I enjoy walking in the Hunua Ranges and on the coastal walks between Maraetai and Beachlands.

The subdivision covers a large area, probably as a result of it being so rural, but the population has rapidly increased in recent years creating a quite diverse range of community.

What previous involvement have you had in local community projects,

organisations, or advocacy, and how have those experiences prepared you to serve effectively on the Local Board?

I am currently vice chairman of the Drury Community Committee which aims to preserve the essence of the Drury community in the face of massive development and disruption. I initiated the social media presence based on the community facebook page, which currently has just short of 1000 followers.

The link to the page is <https://www.facebook.com/drurycomcom>.

I am active in the local Christian community holding various roles over the years and am currently an elder of the Drury Presbyterian Church.

We have actively supported Franklin Hospice and have opened our property a couple of times for their biennial garden ramble.

I have taken an professional interest in zoning designations in the area in my capacity as a real estate agent (now retired).

Prior to working in real estate

I was an information technology professional and in a consulting role worked with a number of New Zealand's largest corporates.

I believe the knowledge I have gained through these experiences would enable me to become an effective member of a local board.

What do you see as the most pressing issues facing Beachlands, Maraetai, Whitford, Clevedon, Hunua and surrounding areas over the next three years, and what specific steps would you take as a Board member to address them?

The most pressing issues facing these communities are those associated with the increasing populations. This places pressure on infrastructure like transport, utilities and facilities. The ward is also home to many fragile environments with much coastline, waterways and native bush. This needs to be preserved and protected from the affects of urbanisation both locally and as a result of its proximity to the densely populated Auckland



Franklin Local Board Wairoa subdivision candidate Chris Caldwell.

City and suburbs precinct.

As a Board Member I would work to ensure that land use is defined so that the conflicting use requirements can be effectively siloed.

BARFOOT THOMPSON

Student Voice

LOCAL STUDENTS' NEWS, VIEWS & LITERARY TALENT

This column features news, views and literary talents of students from Beachlands, Maraetai, Clevedon, Brookby, Hunua, Paparimu, Orere and Ardmore Schools.

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- by Zahn Bracewell, Year 4, Ōrere School

TEAM BRIE RAY WHITE CROSSWORD

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Across

1. Time of intense difficulty (6)

5. Chippies (UK) (6)

8. Lubricate (3)

9. Lariat (5)

12. Sports official (6)

13. Condemn publicly (8)

15. Sacred song (5)

16. Unquenchable (10)

19. Disconnect (10)

20. Gathering of witches (5)

21. Ingratiating (8)

25. Adage (6)

26. Wading bird (5)

27. Stretch out (3)

28. Of course (6)

29. Ringed decoration (6)

Answers on page 14

Down

2. Aggravate (4)

3. Indifferent (2-2)

4. Presently (4)

5. Hint (4)

6. Put upon (6)

7. Vapour (5)

10. Feeling of dread (5)

11. Nourish (7)

13. Dribble (4)

14. French song (7)

15. Pacify (7)

17. Simple musical instrument (5)

18. Fewer (4)

19. Mock (6)

20. Legal expenses (5)

21. Unattractive (4)

22. Masticate (4)

23. Strong desire (4)

24. One (4)

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CROSSWORD ANSWERS

Across: 1. Crisis, 5. Crisps, 8. Oil, 9. Lasso, 12. Um-pire, 13. Denounce, 15. Psalm, 16. Insatiable, 19. Dissociate, 20. Coven, 21. Unctuous, 25. Saying, 26. Heron, 27. Lie, 28. Surely, 29. Wreath. **Down:** 2. Rile, 3. So-so, 4. Soon, 5. Clue, 6. Impose, 7. Steam, 10. Angst, 11. Sustain, 13. Drip, 14. Chanson, 15. Pla-cate, 17. Kazoo, 18. Less, 19. Deride, 20. Costs, 21. Ugly, 22. Chew, 23. Urge, 24. Unit.

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